

THE COST OF INACTION

Ontario’s homelessness crisis — who it affects, where it’s growing, what it costs, and what it would actually take to end it.

C4 CROSS-CAMPUS CAPSTONE

Team C1 — Affordability

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University of Ottawa · Wilfrid Laurier University · York Univeristy

C1

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PARTNERS

HICC · Trek for Teens
Better Street · YSB

1 OUR PROJECT · NOTRE PROJET

Homelessness is usually told through isolated statistics, so the public, policymakers, and even stakeholders underestimate the real, long-term cost of housing insecurity. Instead of asking how to solve homelessness, our team reframed the question:

“What is the cost of doing nothing?”

“C’est quoi Le coût de l’inaction?”

Team deliverables: an awareness campaign and a research-backed infographic that partners can use for advocacy, engagement, and funding applications.

2 THE NUMBERS · LES CHIFFRES

84,973

Ontarians experienced known homelessness in 2025, Up +7.8% in a year

+49.1%

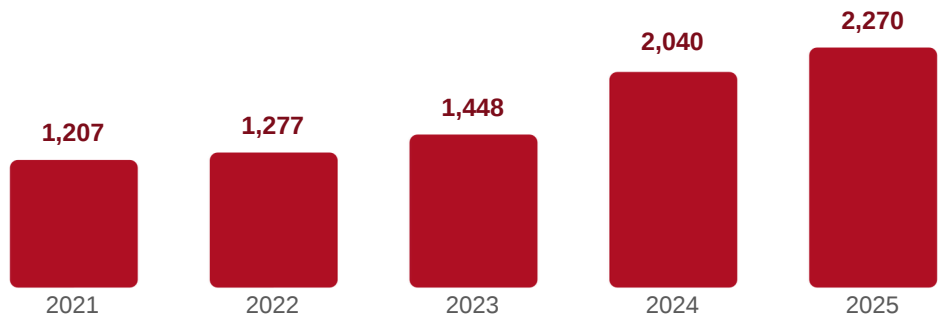
Growth in known homelessness 2021–2025

177,483

Homeless Population projected by 2035 under steady economic conditions

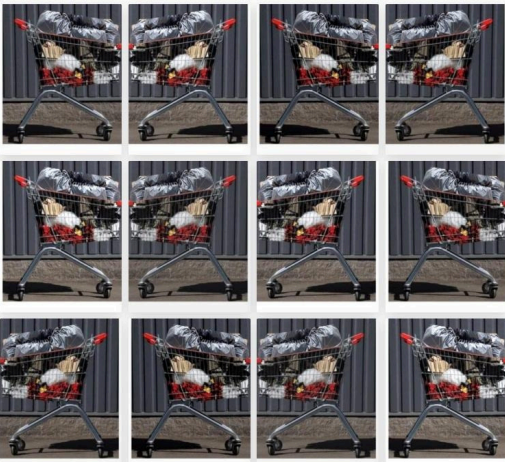
~8,100

People unsheltered at a point in time, in tents, vehicles or unfit spaces



Homelessness Program Spending, Ontario (\$ millions)

3 AWARENESS CAMPAIGN - CAMPAIGN DE SENSIBILISATION



In 2025, 65,000 people experienced homelessness on a single night across 75 Canadian communities.

Scan here to learn more
Source: Everyone Counts 2025, Government of Canada.

Our C1 Project Team



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Project manager



Emily

Facilitator



May

Project Coordinator



Sara

Researcher



Chris

Devil's Advocate

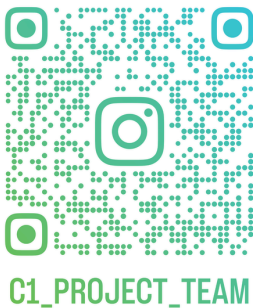
4 CONNECTION TO THE SDGs - CONNECTIONS AU SDGs

Reviewed against all 17 UN SDGs; five are most relevant to our purpose.



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C4 Cross Campus Capstone Classroom



C1_PROJECT_TEAM

